

The Kumbha Mela is held on the bank of Godavari river at an interval of every twelve years. It is also held on the bank of Ganga at Haridwar, on the confluence place of the Ganga and Yamuna (and extinct Saraswati) at Prayag (Prayagraj) and on the bank of River Kshipra (Shipra) at Ujjain.

30. Nathpanthis, Siddhas and Yogis made devotional religion popular in

- (a) Northern India (b) Southern India
(c) Eastern India (d) Western India

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

Nathpanthis, Siddhas and Yogis made Bhakti (devotional) religion popular in Northern India. They criticised the ritual and other aspects of conventional religion and the social order. They also advocated renunciation of the world.

31. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below –

- A. Jainism** 1. Madina
B. Hinduism 2. Vatican
C. Islam 3. Pavapuri
D. Christianity 4. Varanasi

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 3 | 1 | 4 | 2 |
| (b) | 1 | 2 | 4 | 3 |
| (c) | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |
| (d) | 2 | 3 | 1 | 4 |

M.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

Medina is a city located in the Hejaz region of western Saudi Arabia. It is the second holiest city of Islam Religion after Mecca. Vatican City is a sovereign country located in Italy with a total area of 44 hectares which is also the smallest (both in population and area) independent country in the world. It is ruled by the Bishop of Rome who is also called the Pope. It is also known as the capital of the Roman Catholic Church. Pavapuri is the holiest place of Jains located near Rajgir. The founder of Jainism, 'Mahavir Swami' died at Pavapuri in 527 BC. Varanasi is the holiest place for Hindus located on the left bank of Ganga river. This was an important center for education and culture in ancient times.

Sixth century B.C.E - Political Condition

*Buddhist literature, **Anguttaranikaya**, is sufficient to conclude that before the birth of Gautama Buddha, ancient India was divided into 16 major states. They were called '**Sixteen (Shodasha) Mahajanapadas**'. The names of these sixteen Mahajanapadas were Koshal, Kashi, Magadha, Anga, Vajji,

Chedi, Malla, Vatsa, Kuru, Panchal, Matsya, Shurasena, Kamboja, Avanti, Assaka (Ashmaka), and Gandhar. In the Jain literature '**Bhagwatisutra**' also, names of these 16 Mahajanapadas are mentioned with some different names in it. The names of sixteen Mahajanapadas mentioned here are: Anga, Banga, Malay, Acha, Vacha (Vatsa), Magah (Magadha), Malav, Kochachha, Ladh, Moli (Malla), Koshala, Kashi, Padh, Sambhutar, Avaha and Vajji. *22 Mahajanapadas are mentioned in Panini's **Ashtadhyayi**. *The present part of Bihar known as Bhagalpur and Munger district was part of the Anga Mahajanapada. Its capital city was Champa. In Mahabharata and Puranas, its ancient name 'Malini' is mentioned. Champa was considered to be among the six metros of India during Buddha's period. The names of these six metropolises are described in Mahaparinirvan-sutra. These are – Champa, Rajgriha, Benaras, Saket, Kaushambi and Shravasti. *Lichchhavi of Vaishali founded the world's first republic. Vaishali has been called

'**Magadham Puram**' in Suttanipata.

Mahajanapadas	Modern Places	Capital
1. Kuru	Meerut, Delhi and Thaneshwar	Indraprastha
2. Panchal	Bareilly, Badaun, Farrukhabad etc.	Ahichchhatra (North Panchal) and Kampilya (South Panchal)
3. Shurasena	Brajmandal Areas	Mathura
4. Vatsa	Prayagraj and Kaushambi	Kaushambi
5. Koshala	Awadh area (Ayodhya division)	Saket and Shravasti
6. Malla	Kushinagar, Deoria etc. area	Kushinara and Pawa
7. Kashi	Varanasi	Varanasi
8. Anga	Bhagalpur and Munger	Champa
9. Magadha	Patna, Nalanda, Gaya etc.	Girivraj or Rajgrih
10. Vajji	Vaishali, Muzaffarpur, Darbhanga (Bihar) and Mithila area of Nepal	Vaishali
11. Chedi	Eastern Bundelkhand	Sothivati/Suktimati
12. Matsya	Jaipur, Alwar and Bharatpur	Viratnagar
13. Ashmaka	Between Godavari Valley and Narmada Valley	Potan/Potali
14. Avanti	West and Central Malwa region	Ujjayini (N. Avanti) and Mahishmati (S. Avanti)
15. Gandhar	Western part of Pakistan and eastern part of Afghanistan	Taxila
16. Kamboj	Some part of Jammu and Kashmir and Hazara district (Pakistan)	Rajpur/Hatak

*Vaishali was the largest and most powerful republic of the Buddha period. According to Puranas, the first dynasty to rule Magadha was '**Brihadratha**'. The son of the first king of this dynasty was Jarasandha, who made **Girivraj (Rajgriha)** his capital. The Rajgriha has been described as the capital of Jarasandha in the Van Parva of Mahabharata. According to Buddhist texts, the first great ruler of Magadha was **Bimbisara**. He was related to the **Haryanka dynasty**. *The famous historical physician **Jivaka**, contemporary of Lord Buddha was related to the court of Bimbisara. Bimbisara sent Jivaka to the state of Avanti's king **Chandapadyota** for medicinal service. *Bimbisara is said to be the first and most powerful emperor of the Haryanka dynasty who was also the real founder of Magadha Empire.

*The ruler of Magadha, **Ajatashatru** (492-460 BC) killed his father Bimbisara, the founder of Haryanka dynasty and sat on the throne. He was also killed by his son **Udayin** (different from the king Udayan of Vatsa) for the same reason.

***Pataliputra** was founded by Ajatashatru. *Udayin shifted the capital of Magadha Empire from Rajgriha to Pataliputra. It was also the capital of Sishunaga dynasty, Nanda dynasty, and Maurya dynasty. Here Maurya Emperor **Ashok** organised the Third Buddhist Council (247 B.C) which was presided over by **Moggaliputta Tissa**. The first Jain convention was held here too. ***Megasthenes** in his book named '**Indica**' has described the prosperity and the ruling system in the period of Chandragupta Maurya. Pataliputra became the prime centre for Buddhists during the Gupta period. But the importance of this city started declining in later Gupta Period.

*Kashi was the most powerful city in the early 6th century B.C. It was one of the richest and most prosperous Mahajanapadas. Kashi had a long rivalry with Koshala, Anga and Magadha. They always struggled for supremacy.

*In sixth century BC, **Chedi Mahajanapada** was located in modern Bundelkhand and its adjacent parts. Its capital was '**Sotthivati**' which is known as '**Suktimati**' of Mahabharata.

***Kharvel** was the most important emperor of Chedi dynasty of Kalinga. His **Hathigumpha inscription** is the major source of information. The engraving of canals in Kalinga by King **Mahapadmananda** is encrypted in this inscription. It is also the first inscription which tells about the engraving of canals. It describes the donation of villages to Jain monks. This inscription also shows that Kharvel defeated the three states Chola, Chera, and Pandyas of the South.

*The town **Kalpi** is situated in the Jalaun district of Uttar Pradesh on the bank of river Yamuna. During the ancient period, it was famous as 'Kalpriya' which was later known as Kalpi. It was built during 4th century B.C. by King Vasudeva.

***Kuru Mahajanpad** was located in the areas of Meerut, Delhi and Thaneswar. Hastinapur city of Mahabharata was located in this state. *The **Panchala Mahajanapada** was made up

of modern Ruhelkhand areas of Bareilly, Badaun and Farukhabad districts. Initially, there were two parts - the capital of North Panchal was **Ahichchhatra** and the South Panchala was **Kampilya**. The famous city of Kanyakubja was located in Panchala Mahajanpada. The boundaries of the Panchal range from the foothills of the Himalayas to Chambal River in the south, Koshala in the east and Kuru in the west. Panchal was originally a monarchy, but it appears that by the time of Kautilya it became a republic.

***Shurasena Mahajanapada** was founded in the modern Braja mandal. Its capital was Mathura. Ancient Greek writers called this state 'Souraseni' and its capital as 'Mathora'. According to the Buddhist text 'Anguttaranikaya' and Jain text 'Bhagvati-Sutra,' the '**Assaka**' or '**Ashmaka**' was located in between Godavari and Narmada Rivers during the 6th century whose capital was **Paithan/Potan** or **Potali** (Ancient name Prathisthana).

***Avanti Mahajanapada** was found in the area of western and central Malwa. There were two parts of this Mahajanapada - the capital of Northern Avanti was **Ujjayini** and the capital of Southern Avanti was **Mahishmati**. *Ujjayini was the capital of Avanti during the Buddha period. The legend of **Udayan-Vasavadatta** is related to Ujjain. Great poet **Bhaas** has described this story in his drama '**Svapnavasavadattam**', the love story of Vatsa king Udayan and Vasavadatta, the daughter of Avanti King Pradyot. *In the northwestern part of ancient India, which was also called Uttarapatha, there were two Janapadas. These were - Gandhara and Kamboj. **Gandhara Mahajanpada** was extended from western part of Pakistan to eastern part of Afghanistan. It is known from Ramayana that Takshashila Nagar was founded by Taksha, the son of Bharat.

*Four of the sixteen Mahajanpadas - Koshal, Magadha, Vatsa and Avanti were very powerful. Out of the sixteen Mahajanpadas, eight were present in Uttar Pradesh. These were Mahajanpadas - Kashi, Koshal, Vatsa, Malla, Kuru, Panchal, Shurasena and Chedi.

*Bimbisara died in 492 BC. After the Bimbisara, his son 'Kunika' Ajatashatru (is about 492-460 BC) became the ruler of Magadha. He was an imperialist like his father. The struggle between Magadha and Koshala kingdoms started in the early years of his rule. But later, there was a treaty between the ruler of Magadha Ajatashatru and Koshal King Prasenjit. Prasenjit married his daughter, Wajira, to Ajatashatru and again accepted his right over Kashi.

The sequence of the dynasties that ruled Magadh is as follows :

Haryanka dynasty	544 BC - 412 BC
Shishunaga dynasty	412 BC-344 BC
Nanda dynasty	344 BC - 321 BC
Mauryan dynasty	321 BC - 184 BC
Shunga dynasty	184 BC - 75 BC

According to Puranas, the founder of Nanda dynasty, **Mahapadmananda** was a Shudra ruler. He assumed the title of

'Ekkrata' *Chandragupta Maurya had established the Mauryan empire after defeating the last Nanda ruler **Dhanananda** with the help of his preceptor Chanakya. *The Shunga dynasty was founded by Mauryan commander **Pushyamitra Shunga** after killing the last Mauryan ruler **Brihadratha** in 184 BC.

*Nanda dynasty of Magadha was founded after ending Shishunaga dynasty. There were 9 kings in Nanda dynasty- (1) Ugrasen, called Mahapadmananda in Puranas (2) Panduk (3) Pandugati (4) Bhootpal (5) Rastrapal (6) Govishanak (7) Dashasiddhak (8) Kaivart (9) Dhanananda. During last years of Nanda dynasty, the kingdom witnessed turbulence because of extortion and imposition of heavy taxes on small items. Taking advantage of this, Chandragupta Maurya with the help of Chanakya killed Dhananand and established Maurya Empire. **The ruling period of the kings from Bimbisara to Nandas according to Buddhist literature-**

Name of Dynasty	King's Name	Reign
Haryanka (544 - 412 BCE)	Bimbisara	544 - 492 BCE
	Ajatashatru	492 - 460 BCE
	Udayin and his successor	460 - 412 BCE
Shishunaga (412 - 344 BCE)	Shishunaga	412 - 394 BCE
	Kakavarna	394 - 366 BCE
	10 sons of Kakavarna	366 - 344 BCE
Nanda Dynasty (344 - 321 BCE)	Ugrasen, (Mahapadmananda) and their 8 sons	344 - 321 BCE

***Aahat coins** or **Punch marked coins** were the earliest extant coins in India made of silver. The marks on them were made by the stamp, so they were called Aahat coins or Punch marked coins. These coins were found in circulation between 7th-6th centuries B.C and the Mauryan period.

*Panini was known for his Sanskrit grammar. He was born in Pushkalavati, Gandhara. The Ashtadhyayi is one of the earliest known grammars of Sanskrit. The Ashtadhyayi consist of 4000 sutras or rules distributed among (eight chapters) which are each sub-divided into four sections of padas. Panini mentioned as many as 22 different Janapadas but also mentions 3 most important provinces viz. Magadha, Ashmak and Kamboj.

***Nanyadev** was the founder of **Karnata dynasty**. He was a great warrior. The capital of Karnata dynasty was **Simraon**. The period of Karnata dynasty (1097 AD - 1324 AD) was known as the golden period of **Mithila**.

*The last ruler of **Karnata Dynasty** was Harisimha Dev. He was a great patron of art and literature. He was the pro founder of Panji system.

The ruling period of the kings from Bimbisara to Nandas according to the Puranas –

Kings	Reign (in years)
Shishunaga	40
Kakvarna	26
Kshemdharmar	36
Kshemjit or Kshatrojas	24
Bimbisara	28
Ajatashatru	25
Darshak	35
Udayin	33
Nandivardhana	40
Mahanandin	43
Mahapadmananda and his eight sons	100 (40 years according to some scholars).

1. **The earliest extant coins of India were of –**

- (a) Copper (b) Gold
(c) Lead (d) Silver

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (d)

Aahat coins or Punch marked coins were the earliest extant coins in India made up of silver. The marks on them were made by the stamp, so they are called Aahat coins or Punch marked coins.

2. **Which of the following is not correctly matched?**

- (a) Anga- Champa
(b) Koshala - Ahichchhatra
(c) Vatsa - Kaushambi
(d) Matsya - Viratnagar

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (b)

The capital of the Koshala kingdom was Saket and Shravasti. Rest of the other options are correctly matched.

3. **Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:**

List-I (King)	List-II (State)
A.Pradyot	1. Magadha
B.Udyan	2. Vatsa
C.Prasenjit	3. Avanti
D.Ajatshatru	4. Koshala

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	4	3	2	1
(c)	3	2	4	1
(d)	4	1	3	2

U.P. Lower (Spl) (Pre) 2004

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

The Pali scriptures reveal that Pradyot was the king of Avanti. Udayana was the king of Vatsa Mahajanpada. Prasenjit was of Kosala and Ajatashatru was the king of Magadha.

4. Chand-pradyota was the ruler of which ancient republic?

- (a) Kasi (b) Anga
(c) Avanti (d) Vajji

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

Pradyota is the ruler of Avanti. He is said to be the son of Pulika who is said to have killed his master at Ujjain, to make his son the King. Pradyota was a contemporary of Buddha & Bimbisara and found his name in Mahavagga (a part of Vinaya Pitaka) & Puranas. He is said to have ruled for 23 years. Bimbisara sends his Doctor (Raj Vaidhya) Jivak to Pradyota for treatment of Jaundice.

5. The epigraphical evidence reveals that under the instructions of a Nanda king, a canal was dug in :

- (a) Anga (b) Vanga
(c) Kalinga (d) Magadha

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

Hathigumpha inscription indicates the Kalinga victory of Nanda's King Mahapadmananda. According to this, King Nanda took away the statue of King Jinsan and built a canal in Kalinga.

6. What was the ancient name of Ujjain?

- (a) Taxila (b) Indraprastha
(c) Avantika (d) None of above.

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (c)

Ujjain, located in Malwa region of Madhya Pradesh, is considered as the ancient historical town of India. This was one of the two capitals of Avanti which was one among the 16 Mahajanapadas. It is also known as Avantika.

7. The following map shows four of the sixteen mahajanapadas that existed in ancient India :



The places marked A, B, C and D respectively are :

- (a) Matsya, Chedi, Kosala, Anga
(b) Surasena, Avanti, Vatsa, Magadha
(c) Matsya, Avanti, Vatsa, Anga
(d) Surasena, Chedi, Kosala, Magadha

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Options A, B, C, D show Matsya, Avanti, Vatsa and Anga Mahajanapada respectively. Matsya Mahajanapada was located in the Jaipur, Alwar and Bharatpur districts of Rajasthan. Viratnagar was its capital. Avanti Mahajanapada was located in the west and central region of Malwa. It had two parts- Northern Avanti (capital-Ujjayini) and Southern Avanti (capital-Mahishmati). Modern Prayagraj and Kaushambi districts constituted Vatsa Mahajanapada in ancient times. Its capital was Kaushambi. Modern Bhagalpur and Munger districts of Bihar were under the Anga Mahajanapada. Its capital was Champa.

8. The ancient city which is mentioned in the Mahabharata and Mahabhashya both

- (a) Madhyamika (Nagari) (b) Karkot
(c) Viratnagar (Bairat) (d) Raidh

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (*)

The ancient city, which is mentioned in the Mahabharata and Mahabhashya is Madhyamika (Nagari) and Viratnagar. Viratnagar was founded by King Virat. It was the capital of Matsya Kingdom. Its history is found in both Mahabharata and Mahabhashya.

9. Who founded Pataliputra –

- (a) Udayin (b) Ashoka
(c) Bimbisara (d) Mahapadmanada

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (*)

Pataliputra was founded by Ajatashatru, who was the successor of Bimbisara. Udayin shifted the capital of the Magadha Empire from Rajgriha to Pataliputra. It was also the capital of Sishunaga dynasty, Nanda dynasty, and Maurya dynasty.

10. Which of the following statements is true regarding Pataliputra, the capital of the Magadha Kingdom?

- (a) Pataliputra was surrounded by the river Ganges in the East and by the river Champa in the North
(b) Pataliputra was surrounded by the river Ganges in the North and by the river Sone in the West
(c) Pataliputra was surrounded by the Vindhya mountain in the South and by the river Ganges in the East
(d) Pataliputra was surrounded by the Vindhya mountain in the South and by the river Champa in the West

Ans. (b)

Ancient Pataliputra (Modern Patna) was surrounded by the river Ganga in the North and by the river Son in the West.

11. Which ruler had made Pataliputra the capital of his empire for the first time?

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya
- (b) Ashoka the Great
- (c) Chandragupta Vikramaditya
- (d) Kanishka

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Pataliputra was established by Ajatashatru, the ruler of Haryanka dynasty. Udayin transferred the capital from Rajgriha to Pataliputra. But Udayin is not mentioned in the above options. Here, Chandragupta Maurya will be the correct answer.

12. Who among the following kings had founded Pataliputra?

- (a) Sisunaga
- (b) Bimbisara
- (c) Ajatashatru
- (d) Udayin

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

13. By which ruler was Pataliputra chosen as the capital for the first time?

- (a) Ajatashatru
- (b) Kalashoka
- (c) Udayin
- (d) Kanishka

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

14. In ancient times, the area to the south of the Ganga was known as

- (a) Anarta
- (b) Takshashila
- (c) Chola
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (e)

In ancient times the area along river to the south of Ganga was known as Magadha. Takshashila was situated between Indus and Jhelum. Chola was situated in the south of Godavari river. Anarta was a Vedic era kingdom of ancient India. Hence option (e) none of the above is correct answer.

15. The Legend of Udayan-Vasavadatta is related to-

- (a) Ujjain
- (b) Mathura
- (c) Mahishmati
- (d) Kaushambi

U.P. Lower (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

The legend of Udayan-Vasavadatta is related to Ujjain. Great poet Bhaas has described this story in his drama 'Svapnavasavadattam', the love story of Vatsa king Udayan and Vasavadatta, the daughter of Avanti King Pradyot. The story is set during the time when Udayan was imprisoned in Ujjayini.

16. In which century did the first Magadhan Empire rise?

- (a) Fourth Century B.C.
- (b) Sixth Century B.C.
- (c) Second Century B.C.
- (d) First Century B.C.

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

The first Magadhan empire flourished in 6th century B.C. The actual founder of this empire was king Bimbisara (approximately 544-492 century B.C). He was related to Haryanka dynasty.

17. Which one of the following was initially the most powerful city-state in India in the 6th century B.C.?

- (a) Gandhar
- (b) Kamboj
- (c) Kashi
- (d) Magadha

I.A.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

Magadha was the most powerful city in the early 6th century B.C. It was one of the richest and most prosperous Mahajanapada among others. Magadha had a long rivalry with Koshala, Anga and Kashi. They always struggled for supremacy.

18. Which one was not in the earlier Republic?

- (a) Shakya
- (b) Lichchhavi
- (c) Yaudheya
- (d) All of the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (c)

The evidence of the existence of lots of republics is found during the Buddha period. They were as follows- (1) Shakya of Kapilavastu, (2) Bhagga of Sumsumaragiri, (3) Buli of Alakappa, (4) Kalam of Kesaputta, (5) Koliya of Ramgama, (6) Malla of Kusinara, (7) Malla of Pava, (8) Moriya of Pipphalivan, (9) Lichchhavi of Vaishali and (10) Videha of Mithila. Yaudheya was not in the earlier republic.

19. By whom the first republic of the world was established in Vaishali -

- (a) Maurya
- (b) Nanda
- (c) Gupta
- (d) Lichchhavi

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

The Lichchhavi dynasty of Vaishali established the first republic in the world. Vaishali took its name from King Vishal of the Mahabharata era. Vaishali is a great Buddhist pilgrimage site and also the birthplace of Lord Mahavira.

20. Where was the first republican system of the world during 6th century B.C. located?

- (a) Vaishali (b) Athens
(c) Sparta (d) Pataliputra

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

21. Which one of the following pair is correctly matched?

- (a) Parsvanath - Janatrika
(b) Bindusara-Shakya
(c) Skandagupta-Maurya
(d) Chetak-Lichchhavi

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

King Chetak was the emperor of the Lichchhavi republic. His daughter Chelana was married to Magadha King Bimbisara. Lichchhavi was one of the clans of the union of Vajji.

22. Which Buddha text has described 16 Mahajanpads of 6th century B.C.?

- (a) Digha Nikaya (b) Tripitaka
(c) Deepavansh (d) Anguattar Nikaya

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl.) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (d)

The 16 Mahajanapads of 6th century B.C. were mentioned in Buddhist text 'Anguttara Nikaya'. They were as follows- Anga, Magadha, Kashi, Kosala, Vajji, Malla, Chedi, Vatsa, Kuru, Panchal, Matsya, Shurasena, Ashmaka, Avanti, Gandhara and Kamboj. The list of 16 Mahajanapadas also finds mention in Jain text Bhagavati Sutra.

23. The list of sixteen Mahajanapadas is available in –

- (a) Mahabharata (b) Anguttar Nikaya
(c) Chandogya Upanishad (d) Samyukta Nikaya

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

24. Which one of the following Buddhist texts describes the sixteen Mahajanapadas?

- (a) Anguttara Nikaya (b) Majjhima Nikaya
(c) Khuddaka Nikaya (d) Digha Nikaya

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

25. 16 Janpadas of the age of Mahajanapada have often been mentioned in the Buddhist literature which of the following Janapadas have been mentioned by Panini in his Ashtadhyayi?

- A. Magadh B. Ashmak
C. Kamboj D. Chedi
E. Vatsa

Select the correct answer from the codes given below.

Code :

- (a) A, B and C (b) D and E
(c) C, D and E (d) A, C, D and E

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Re. Exam) (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

Panini is known for his Sanskrit grammar. He was born in Pushkalavati, Gandhara. The Ashtadhyayi is one of the earliest known grammars of Sanskrit. The Ashtadhyayi consists of 4000 sutras or rules distributed among (eight chapters) which are each subdivided into four sections of padas. Panini mentioned as many as 22 different Janapadas but also mentioned 3 most important Janapadas viz. Magadha, Ashmak and Kamboj.

26. In which of the following texts the list of the sixteen great states (Shodasha Mahajanapadas) of ancient India occur? Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- (i) Arthashastra (ii) Anguttara Nikaya
(iii) Digha Nikaya (iv) Bhagavati Sutra

Code :

- (a) (ii) and (iv) (b) (ii), (iii) and (iv)
(c) (i) and (ii) (d) (i), (ii) and (iii)

R.A.S. /R.T.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

27. The capital of North Panchal, according to Mahabharata, was located at :

- (a) Hastinapur (b) Indraprastha
(c) Ahichhatra (d) Mathura

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (c)

The capital of Northern Panchala was Ahichchhatra and Kampilya was the capital of southern Panchala. Hastinapura and Indraprastha were the capital of Kuru while Mathura was the capital of Shurasena.

28. During the period of 16 Mahajanapadas, Mathura was the capital of –

- (a) Vajji (b) Vatsa
(c) Kashi (d) Surasena

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

29. Champa was the capital of which Mahajanapada?

- (a) Magadha (b) Vajji
(c) Kosala (d) Anga

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (d)

Champa (Campa) was the capital of Anga Mahajanapada. It covers the modern districts of Munger and Bhagalpur in Bihar. It was later annexed to Magadha by Bimbisara. Magadha was located to its west.

30. In the sixth century B.C. Suktimati was the capital of

- (a) Panchala (b) Kuru
(c) Chedi (d) Avanti

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

Ans. (c)

In sixth century BC, Chedi Mahajanapada was located in modern Bundelkhand and its adjacent parts. Its capital was 'Sotthivati' which is known as 'Suktimati' of Mahabharata.

31. Mahajanapada situated on the bank of river Godavari was-

- (a) Avanti (b) Vatsa
(c) Assaka (d) Kamboja

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

According to the Buddhist text 'Anguttara Nikaya' and Jain text 'Bhagavati Sutra,' the 'Assaka' or 'Ashmaka' was located in between Godavari and Narmada rivers during the 6th century whose capital was Paithan/Potan or Potali (Ancient name Prathisthana).

32. Matsya Mahajanapada of 6th Century B.C. was located in:

- (a) Western Uttar Pradesh (b) Rajasthan
(c) Bundelkhand (d) Rohilkhand

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

Matsya Mahajanapad (6th century B.C.) was situated around areas of Jaipur, Alwar and Bharatpur in Rajasthan. Its capital was Viratnagar.

33. Which was the capital of Magadha?

- (a) Pratishthan (b) Vaishali
(c) Girivraj (Rajgriha) (d) Champa

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

Rajgriha was the first capital of Magadha, (Where first 'Buddhist Council' was organized and Lord Mahavir sermoned first). According to Puranas, the first dynasty to rule over Magadh was Brihadrath dynasty. King Brihadrath's son, Jarasandha, made Girivraja (Rajgir) his capital. Later on, Udayin, son of Ajatashatru, moved the capital to Patliputra.

34. Which was the initial capital of Magadha?

- (a) Pataliputra (b) Vaishali
(c) Girivraja (Rajgriha) (d) Champa

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

35. Which was the first capital of ancient Mahajanapada Magadh?

- (a) Pataliputra
(b) Vaishali
(c) Champa
(d) Anga
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2020

Ans. (e)

Magadh was an ancient kingdom in Bihar. Its first capital was Rajgriha (Modern day Rajgir) which was also known as Girivraj. During the reign of Udayin (Haryanka dynasty) Capital was moved to Pataliputra.

36. Which city served as the capital of the ancient kingdom of Magadha during the early Vedic period?

- (a) Rajgriha (b) Campa
(c) Vaishali (d) Pataliputra

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

37. Which one of the following was not a capital of Magadhan Empire?

- (a) Girivraja (b) Rajgriha
(c) Pataliputra (d) Kaushambi

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

Girivraja or Rajgriha and Pataliputra were the capitals of the Magadha Empire respectively in ancient times while Kaushambi was ruled by Vatsa state. The capital of Magadha was shifted from Rajgriha to Pataliputra by Haryanka dynasty ruler Udayin.

38. What is the town configuration of ancient Shravasti?

- (a) Circular (b) Crescentic
(c) Triangular (d) Quadratic

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

Alexander Cunningham identified the ancient Shravasti at Sahet-Mahet placed near Shravasti in Uttar Pradesh in 1861. It is known by excavations that the configuration of Shravasti was in crescentic form.

39. Which initial ruler of Magadha killed his father for enthroning and also was killed by his son for the same reason?

- (a) Bimbisara (b) Ajatshatru
(c) Udayin (d) Nagdashak

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (b)

The ruler of Magadha, Ajatashatru (492-460 BC) killed his father Bimbisara, the founder of Haryanka dynasty and sat on the throne. He was also killed by his son Udayin (different from the king Udayan of Vatsa) for the same reason.

40. Which of the following great ruler founded the "Haryanka Vansh" in ancient Bihar?

- (a) Bimbisara
(b) Brihadrath
(c) Ajatshatru
(d) More than one of the above

70th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

41. What was the name of the dynasty of Ajatshatru?

- (a) Maurya (b) Haryanka
(c) Nanda (d) Gupta

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

42. The Prince who was responsible for the death of his father was-

- (a) Ajatashatru (b) Chandapradhyota
(c) Prasenjit (d) Udayan

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

43. Who defeated and assimilated the Vajjis into the empire of Magadha?

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya (b) Asoka
(c) Mahapadma Nanda (d) Ajatshatru

[Jharkhand P.S.C. (Mains)-2016]

Ans. (d)

Vaishali was the principal republic of the Vajji confederacy. The ruler of this place were Lichchhavi. From the time of Bimbisara, there was estrangement in the Magadha and Vajji Confederations, which turned into conflict during the time of Ajatashatru. It is known from Nirayavali sutra that at that time Chetak was chief of Lichchhavi. He prepared a united front of 9 Lichchhavis, 9 Mallas and 18 Ganrajayas (of Kashi-Koshala) against the king of Magadha. As per Bhagavati Sutta, Ajatashatru was winner of all of them. He defeated Lichchhavis and annexed the Vajjis to the Magadha.

44. Power of Magadha was extended over the Malwa region during the reign period of –

- (a) Bimbisara (b) Ajatshatru
(c) Udayabhadra (d) Sisunaga

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

According to Matsya Puranas, king of Magadha, Shishunaga annexed Avanti (Malwa) into his empire by defeating Nandivardhan.

45. Who was the founder of Nanda Dynasty in Magadha?

- (a) Mahapadmananda (b) Dhanananda
(c) Nandivardhan (d) Mahanandin

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

After Shishunaga dynasty, the Nanda dynasty started ruling Magadha. Mahapadmananda or Ugrasen was the founder of Nanda dynasty. He was also called as Sarvakshatrantaka and Aparoparashurama in Puranas.

46. Which dynasty ruled Magadh (Bihar) after Shishunag dynasty ?

- (a) Maurya Vansh
(b) Sunga Vansh
(c) Nanda Vansh
(d) More than one of the above

70th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

47. Which King of Magadha is known as Aparoparashurama?

- (a) Bindusara (b) Ajatasatru
(c) Kalasoka (d) Mahapadmananda

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

48. Who among the following made Varanasi his second capital?

- (a) Ajatashatru (b) Kalashok
(c) Mahapadmananda (d) Shishunag

[U.P.G.I.C. Lecturer, 2007]

Ans. (*)

In 6th century BC Varanasi was the capital of Kashi Mahajanapada. It was received as dowry by Haryanka dynasty king Bimbisara when he married Mahakoshala, the sister of Koshala king Prasenjit. During the period of Ajatashatru, Prasenjit married his daughter Vajira with him and accepted his suzerainty over Kashi. Later on when Shishunag made Vaishali his capital, he appointed his son as deputy-king of Varanasi. Hence, it is not very clear from given options that who made Varanasi his second capital. However U.P.P.S.C. has accepted Shishunag as correct option.

49. Which dynasty did rule over Magadha after Nanda Dynasty?

- (a) Maurya (b) Shunga
(c) Gupta (d) Kushana

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

Nanda dynasty of Magadha was founded after the end of Shishunaga dynasty. There were 9 kings in Nanda dynasty- (1) Ugrasen, called Mahapadmananda in Puranas (2) Panduk (3) Pandugati (4) Bhootpal (5) Rastrapal (6) Govishanak (7) Dashasiddhak (8) Kaivart (9) Dhanananda. During last years of Nanda dynasty, people became turbulent because of extortion and imposition of heavy taxes on small items. By taking advantage of this, Chandragupta Maurya with the help of Chanakya killed Dhananand and established Maurya Empire. Thus option (a) is correct.

50. Which inscription is the evidence of King Nand?

- (a) Hathigumpha inscription of Kharvel
(b) Rummindei pillar inscription
(c) Junagarh inscription of Rudradamana
(d) Ayodhya inscription of Dhandeva.

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Mains) 2010

Ans. (a)

Kharvel was the most important emperor of Chedi dynasty of Kalinga. His Hathigumpha inscription is the major source of information about his reign. The engraving of canals in Kalinga by King Mahapadmananda is encrypted in this inscription. It is also the first inscription which tells about the engraving of canals. It mentions the donation of villages to Jain monks. This inscription also mentions that Kharvel defeated the three states Chola, Chera, and Pandyas of the south. Thus, option (a) is the correct answer.

51. Arrange the following Magadhan dynasties in the chronological order

1. Nandas 2. Sungas
3. Mauryas 4. Haryankas

Choose the answer from the following codes :

- (a) 2, 1, 4 and 3 (b) 4, 1, 3 and 2
(c) 3, 2, 1 and 4 (d) 1, 3, 4 and 2

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The sequence of these dynasties are as follows:-

Haryanka dynasty	544 BC - 412 BC
Nanda dynasty	344 BC - 321 BC
Mauryan dynasty	321 BC - 184 BC
Shunga dynasty	184 BC - 75 BC

52. Jivaka, the famous physician of the time of Mahatma Buddha, was associated with the court of –

- (a) Bimbisara (b) Chanda Pradyota
(c) Prasenjit (d) Udyana

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (a)

The famous historical physician Jivaka, a contemporary of Lord Buddha, was related to the court of Bimbisara. Bimbisara had sent Jivaka to the state of Avanti's king Chandapadyota for medicinal service.

53. Who was the Physician of Magadh ruler Bimbisara?

- (a) Shilabhadra (b) Vijayasena
(c) Jeevaka (d) Manu
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2022

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

54. Read the statements (A) and (B) and choose the correct answer from the code given below :

- (A) The sixth century B.C. was a period of great religious upheaval in all parts of the world.
(B) The Vedic religion had become very complex.

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (B) are false.
(b) Both (A) and (B) are true.
(c) (A) is true, while (B) is false.
(d) (A) is false, while (B) is true.

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (b)

Many religious sects came into existence across the middle Ganga valley of northern India during sixth century B.C., which witnessed an intellectual environment due to the emergence of many new faiths and beliefs. The hermits following different faiths started preaching their thoughts and disclaiming each other's philosophies. It should be noted during that time, such type of intellectual movements also emerged in other countries of the world. Confucius, Zarathustra and Pythagoras were the people who challenged the traditional assumptions in China, Iran and Greece respectively. Vedic religion became complicated. There was more focus on purity of Shlokas and Yajnas. As a result, the importance of priests increased enormously. It began to spend much money on Yajnas and also motivated animal killings.

55. The town of Kalpi is situated on the bank of the river –

- (a) Ganga (b) Yamuna
(c) Narmada (d) Krishna

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (b)

The town Kalpi is situated in the Jalaun district of Uttar Pradesh on the bank of river Yamuna. During the ancient period, it was famous as Kalprianath or Kalpriya Nagari, which was later known as Kalpi. It was built during 4th century A.D. by King Vasudeva.